



Winning holiday moments: Practical strategies for seasonal success

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Today's speaker



Monica Orsino *(she, her, hers)*
Senior Learning Consultant

Best practices this holiday - Agenda

1

Phase 1 – Wrap the Basics - July & August

Product Feeds, Measurement, and Bidding Foundations

2

Phase 2 – Gift them a Reason - September & October

Create Consideration Early

3

Phase 3- Ring in the Sales - November & December

Capture the Holiday Moment

4

Phase 4- Unbox What's Next – December & January

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot messaging, capture post-holiday demand and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

What you'll be able to do this holiday season

1

Phase 1 · Prepare for success — audit product feeds, confirm conversion tracking, and structure your full-funnel campaign mix across Search, Shopping, PMax, and AI Max before demand builds.

2

Phase 2 · Engage shoppers early with seasonal in-market audiences, remarketing, and fresh creative to build demand before peak.

3

Phase 3 · Capture peak demand using automated bidding, seasonality adjustments, and conversion value rules during Cyber Week.

4

Phase 4 · Measure and learn by evaluating results, accounting for conversion delays, and applying learnings to next season.

The three eras of holiday shopping

Discovery is shifting from browsing, to asking, to acting — and AI readiness is the thread.

1

The human web

Shoppers browse and search. People find products by typing queries and clicking through results.

2

The LLM web

Shoppers ask. People turn to AI assistants like Copilot to compare, summarize, and get recommendations.

3

The agentic web

AI acts. Assistants increasingly find, evaluate, and complete purchases on the shopper's behalf.

To be discovered, understood, recommended, and chosen, your brand must be easy for AI to read — the foundation for Merchant Center, Clarity, Audience Ads, Performance Max, and AI Max.

The four phases of Holiday

Phase 01: Wrap the basics - July & August

Product feeds, measurement, and
bidding foundations

Phase 03: Ring in the sales - November & December

Capture the holiday moment

Phase 02: Gift them a reason - September & October

Create consideration early

Phase 04: Unbox what's next – December & January

Measure results, uncover learnings, pivot
messaging, capture post-holiday demand
and maximize post-holiday opportunities.

WINNING HOLIDAY MOMENTS

Phase 1: Wrap the Basics



Phase 01

Wrap the basics & get setup for success – **July / August**

A strong holiday strategy starts with the right foundation

The fundamentals still win with:

1. **Well-structured media mix** with the optimal campaign portfolio;
2. **Up-to-date, comprehensive product feeds and inventory**;
3. **First-party data** and relevant **seasonal audiences** reach the right customers at the right time.
4. **Accurate Tracking and Measurement** in place with Universal Event Tracking (**UET**) and Merchant Center, **conversion tracking, automated bidding, and meaningful conversion values**)

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 1:

Prep & planning

Before demand peaks



"We've already learned everything from last year."

"Black Friday is when holiday starts."

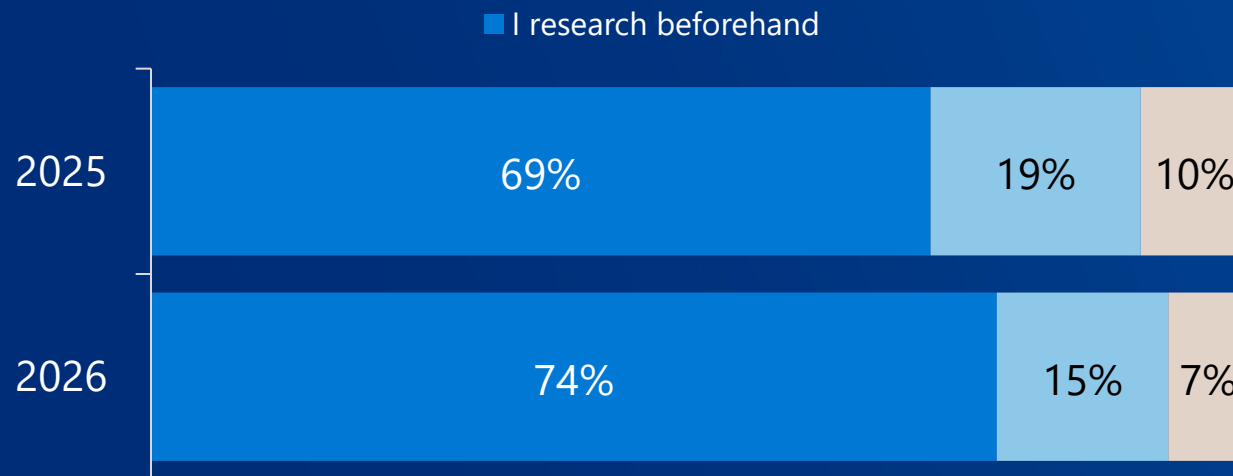
"Remarketing audiences will build themselves."

- Consumer behavior, competition, and shopping trends evolve every season.
- Winning advertisers start building demand, audiences, and momentum weeks before peak shopping events.
- Success is built before Cyber Week through audience growth, testing, and campaign learning.
- Strong audience pools require early planning and accumulation.

Shoppers are planning earlier for major sales events

Nearly 3 in 4 shoppers now research products before Black Friday and/or Cyber Monday.

Approach to product research for key shopping events Share of Respondents



Note: responses may not sum to 100% as the response "unsure" was removed.
Survey QQ: Which of the following statements best describes how you approach researching products for a shopping event, such as Black Friday or Cyber Monday?

Activate:



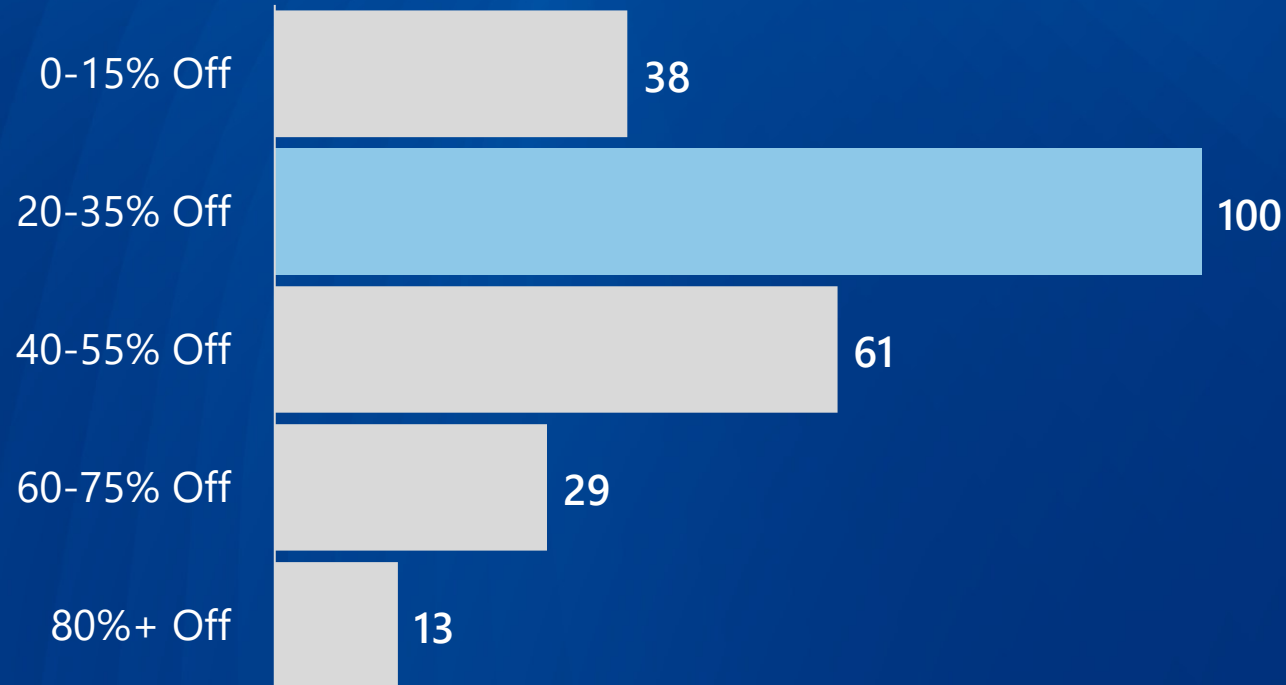
- Search
- Shopping Campaigns
- PMax
- Audience Ads



Before promotions are live to reach shoppers while you can still influence them.

Holiday shoppers are mostly searching for 20-35% offers

Q4 indexed search volume by offer



Tease offers early with:

➤ Audience ads



Helps build awareness



Use:

➤ Merchant Promotions



Highlight available deals

Build structures that support learning

Consolidate fragmented campaigns when volume is limited — a campaign with fewer than 30 conversions in 30 days is a candidate for consolidation.



Reserve **Exact Match** for critical coverage of **must-have search terms**.



Consider **portfolio bid strategies** for groups of campaigns with similar intent and margins.



Use **Broad Match, AI Max, and Performance Max** as the exploration layer to **capture incremental demand** across Search, Copilot, and other surfaces.

Maximize coverage across Microsoft Advertising

Different campaign types serve different objectives.



Most advertisers benefit from multiple solutions working together.



Define the right campaign mix

Standard Search

EXACT-MATCH CONTROL

Target exact match keywords to hold tight control over your highest-value, high-intent queries.

Audience ads

CAPTURE AND NURTURE DEMAND

Capture mid-to-upper funnel demand and nurture towards conversion.

Performance Max

CROSS-CHANNEL REACH

AI that maximizes performance across Microsoft's full ecosystem.

Customization

Automation

Standard shopping

PRECISION & CONTROL

A catalog catch-all — or product-level control where you need it.

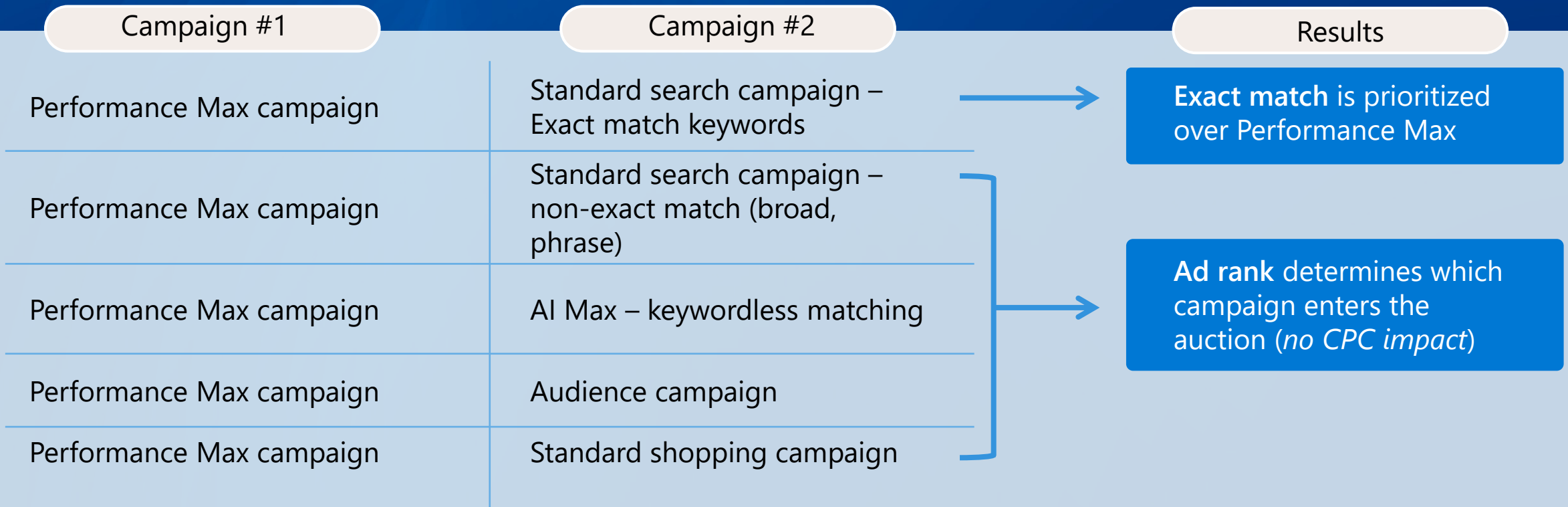
AI Max

SEARCH THAT SCALES

Lifts Search performance, widens query coverage, and captures high-intent demand.

How different campaigns interact with each other

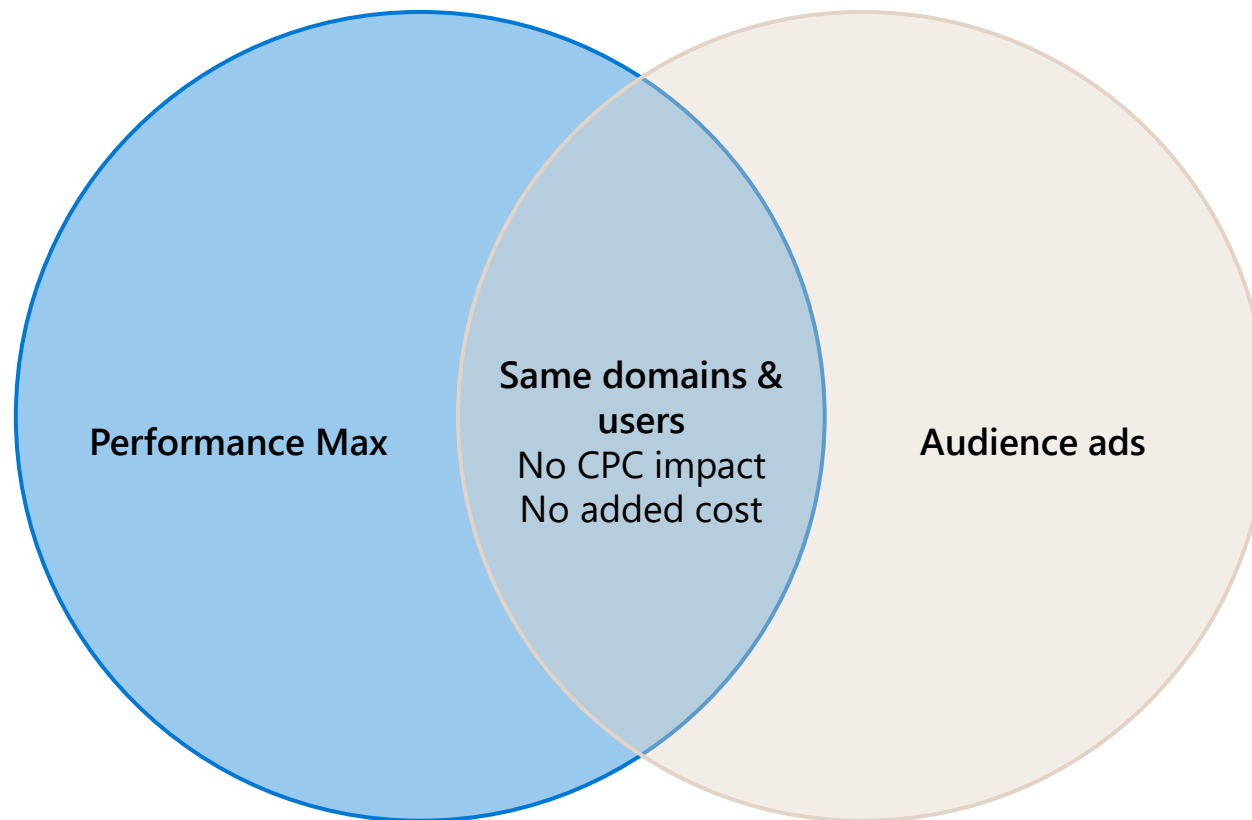
Ad delivery for Search campaigns using exact match keywords is prioritized over Performance Max campaigns. For all other campaign types, the campaign with the highest ad rank will serve.



Using Performance Max and Audience ads together

No risk of cannibalization or inflating CPC between PMax and Audience ads

- **No CPC impact** across accounts, even when both campaigns target the same domain.
- **Audience overlap:**
If campaigns share identical goals, they may pursue the same users with no impact on CPCs or cost.



Use Audience Ads impression-based remarketing list as an audience signal on your PMax campaign.

AI Max or PMax?

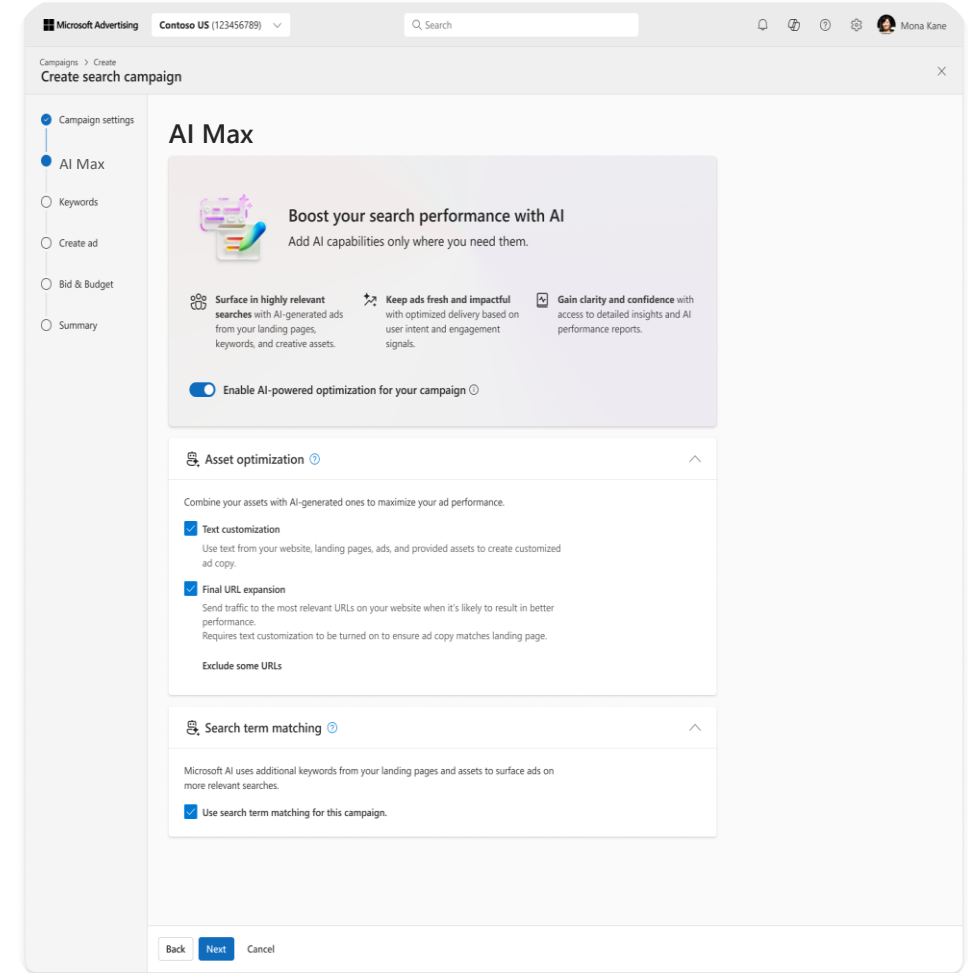
01 AI MAX

Adds **automation** to standard **Search** and augment Search campaigns: it expands AI matching, personalizes creative, etc. with the control and transparency of Search.

02 Performance Max

A separate **cross-channel** campaign type built to maximize reach and automation **across all of Microsoft's channels**, trading some control for **full automation**.

AI Max enhances **Search** with a balance of control and automation;
Use **PMax** for **maximum** reach and **automation** across every channel.

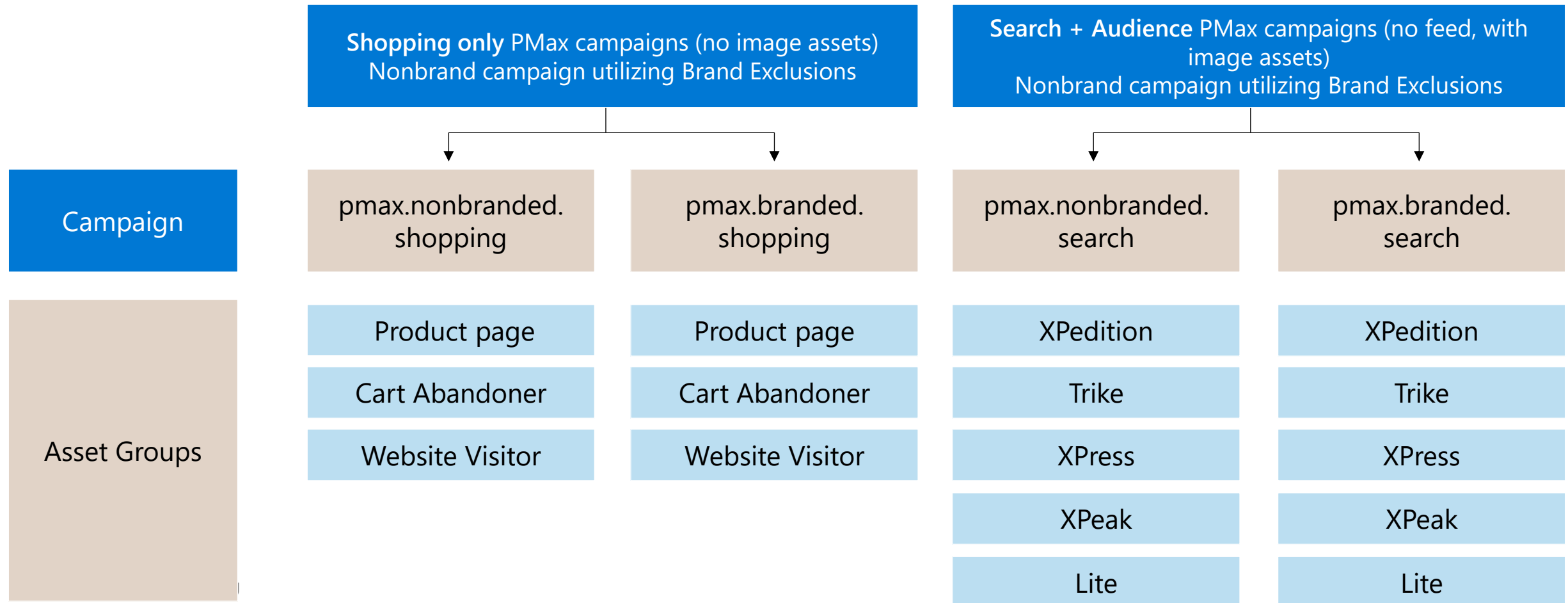


Retail Client Campaign Structure example

Structure by shopping network vs Search + audience and then by brand and non-brand.

Shopping campaigns further broken by audiences. Search + Audience are broken by product type at asset group level

At least 30 conversions in 30 days.



AI Readiness Matters



JD Sports enters its next growth phase with an AI-ready strategy after **clicks jump 747%**



The results



Summary

- **The goal:** Prepare for AI-driven discovery during peak season
- **The solution:** Align campaigns with key business priorities
- **The strategy:** PMAX to capture cross-channel demand, Broad Match to expand relevant queries, and Auto-Bidding to react in real-time
- **The results:** Record revenue when demand was highest

“We know that our customers are increasingly using AI-enabled experiences for inspiration. We want to show up for our customers where they are, so we launched a new AI-led structure ahead of peak. This gave the platform a fuller view of intent, turning inspiration moments into buying decisions.”

Liza Nolan

Associate Director of Digital Media
JD Sports

AI readiness in Merchant Center

Make your products discoverable.

Richer product details help improve Copilot answers and drive greater engagement



Provide your entire catalog

Do this:

Upload 100% of your catalog so your product can be discoverable in Copilot shopping and organic experiences.



Set up UCP in Merchant Center (Universal Commerce Protocol)

Do this:

1. In Merchant Center > UCP settings: Input your return policy and customer support contact info.

2. Update your feed to be AI-ready and support UCP.



Update your product feed to be AI-ready and support UCP

Do this:

native_commerce (*Copilot Checkout*)
merchant_item_id (*unique ID tracks item across feeds and systems*)
consumer_notice_type and **consumer_notice_message** (*consumer warning*)
Add if regulatory compliance requirements apply



UCP is an industry standard language that lets AI assistants, platforms, and online stores work together to enable online shopping.

Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist



THE BASICS

Ensure the foundation is in place.

- ☐ **Upload your entire product catalog for AI readiness** so products are discoverable in Copilot shopping.
- ☐ **Required fields** are complete
- ☐ **No duplicate titles**
Differentiate titles for variant offerings with the color, size, materials, etc.
- ☐ **GTIN/MPN** is valid
- ☐ **Pricing** is correct and up to date
- ☐ **Product page URLs** correct and work
- ☐ **All products** are included in feed
- ☐ **Image URL** should be accessible and have a good image of your product
- ☐ Use **custom labels** to tag holiday hero products, best sellers, and strategic inventory



THE OPPORTUNITIES

More details in feeds is better.

- ☐ **Strong product titles**
Create robust titles with product details.
- ☐ **Long product descriptions**
Confirm accuracy and that they match landing page descriptions.
- ☐ **Recommended fields**
Provide more metadata to help ads match to more relevant searches.
- ☐ **Product categorization**
Clarify what your product is.
- ☐ **Routine updates to feed**
Automate price and status updates.
- ☐ **Confirm feed parity with Google.**
Get the same products. Import can help.
- ☐ **UCP attributes.**
Add return policy, customer support

Top driver: Optimize product titles & descriptions for holiday

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Good:

Travel sized lavender hand cream

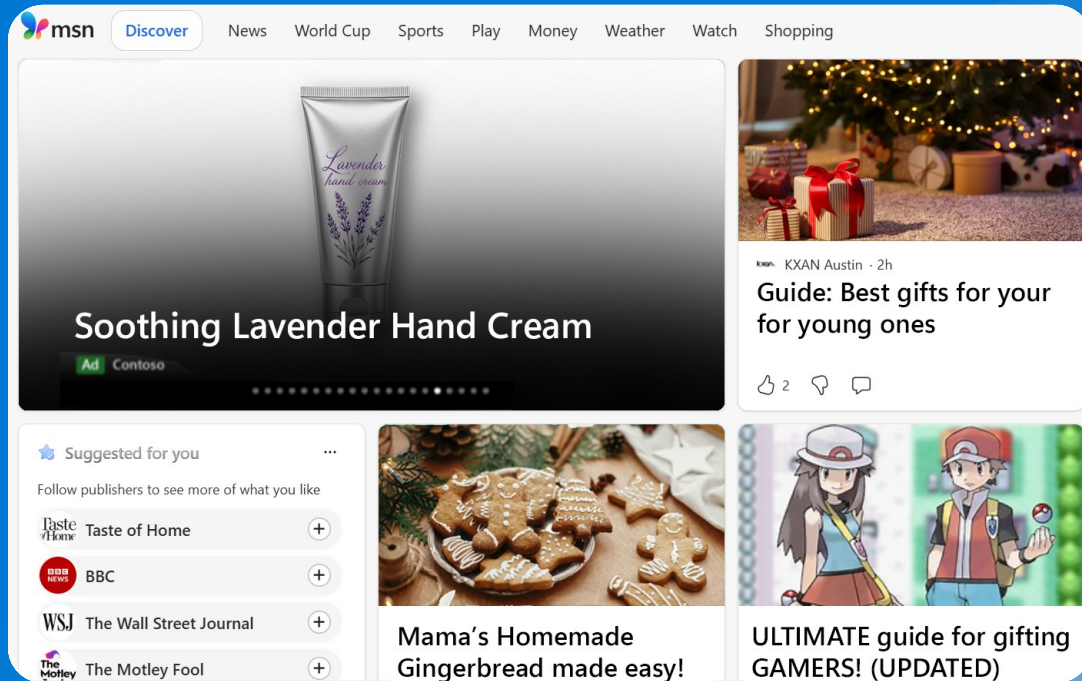
Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this smooth, **light-textured cream** gently helps to nourish the hands leaving them softly perfumed.

Better for holidays:

2.6 oz lavender shea butter hand cream

Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this **lightweight hand cream** helps nourish hands and leave them softly perfumed. At **2.6 oz**, it's ideal as a **small gift for a coworker**, and it provides the nourishment needed during the **wintertime**.

Expand your feed to display and native placements



Product feeds & Audience Ads

Use your existing feed from search and expand into display and native.



When combined with Microsoft AI intent signals, we'll match users with the items in your feed that they've shown interest in.

Develop audience strategies early



- Leverage your First Party Data for Audiences!
- Build audience lists early to ensure sufficient scale before peak.
- Separate prospecting and retargeting into distinct campaigns with tailored bids and messaging.
- In-Market and Similar Audiences are great for acquisition and prospecting.
- Build Remarketing, Dynamic Remarketing, and Customer Match for re-engagement and personalized offers during peak
- Impression-Based Remarketing creates audience lists from ad exposure.
- Activate seasonal audiences such as Black Friday and Christmas segments.

Search themes are additive signals

Seasonal

Travel Tuesday ✕ Black Friday Car Rental Discounts ✕
Travel Deals ✕ (Brand Promotion Name) ✕

- Search Term Insights report helps identifying high-performing queries
- Search Themes are up to 50
- They do not cap volume

 Search Themes 

Words or phrases that people search for on Bing (up to 50)

black friday sports apparel deals ✕

cyber monday athletic wear sale ✕

black friday gym clothes discounts ✕

cyber monday workout gear deals ✕

(brand promotion name) ✕

athletic wear clearance sale ✕

limited time fitness apparel sale ✕

best black friday running gear deals ✕

gifts for runners ✕

fitness gifts for men ✕

workout gifts for women ✕

christmas gifts for athletes ✕

activewear gift ideas ✕

stocking stuffers for fitness lovers ✕

running shoes and apparel ✕

mens workout clothes ✕

womens activewear sets ✕

gym outfits for training ✕

performance workout gear ✕

breathable athletic clothing ✕



Type desired theme and press enter to add

Set up Automated Bidding, Seasonality Adjustments, Attribution models before peak periods

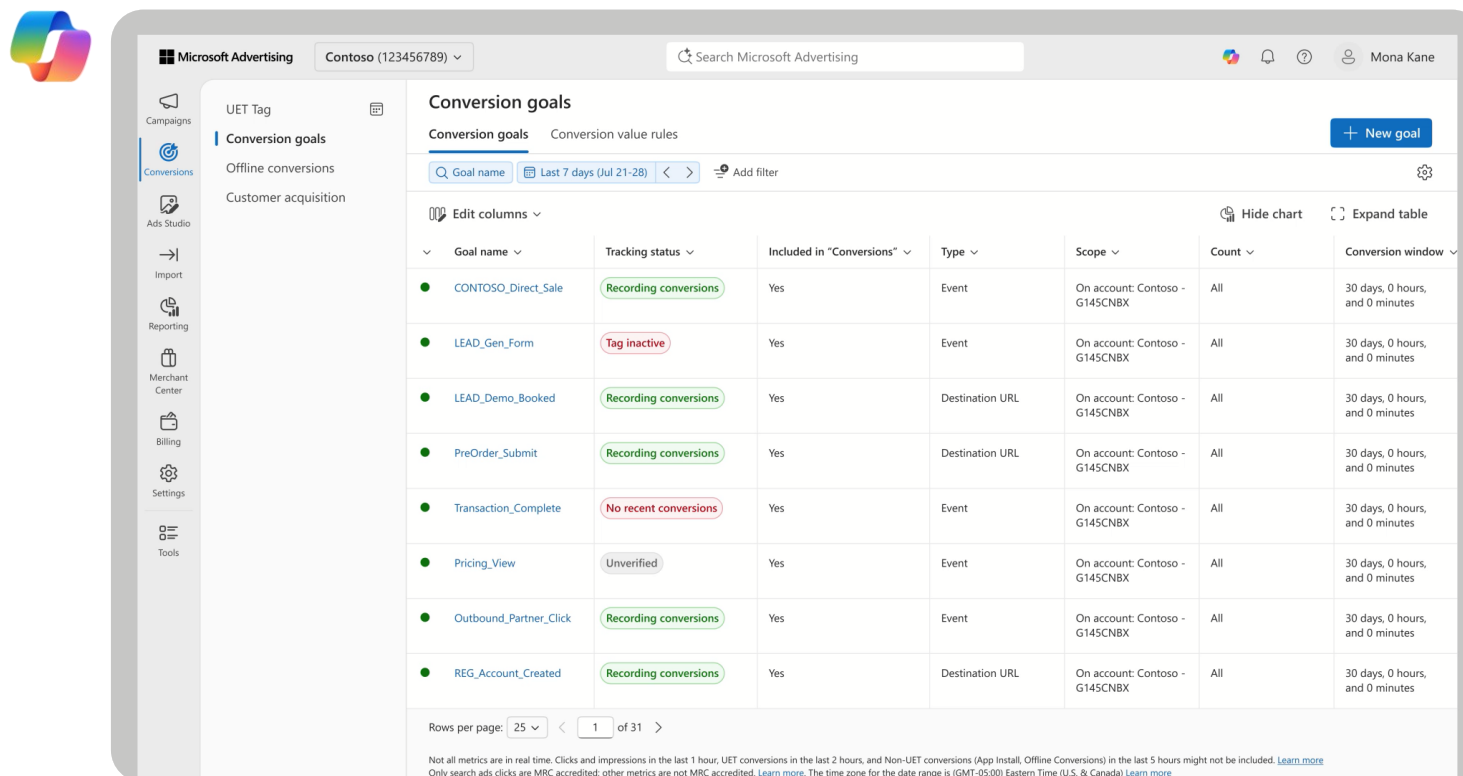


Validate your measurement foundation

Audit UET implementation monthly and after major site updates. Incomplete or misfiring tags limit optimization.

Validate tracking end-to-end from click through conversion reporting.

- Copilot in MAP: Use a prompt like: ***Test my '[Conversion Goal Name]' goal and confirm if UET is configured correctly on my site.***
- Use **Test This Goal** feature on conversion goal grid



The screenshot shows the Microsoft Advertising interface for Contoso (123456789). The left sidebar contains navigation links for Campaigns, Conversion goals (selected), Offline conversions, Customer acquisition, Ads Studio, Import, Reporting, Merchant Center, Billing, Settings, and Tools. The main content area is titled 'Conversion goals' and includes a search bar, a date range filter (Last 7 days), and a '+ New goal' button. Below this is a table with columns: Goal name, Tracking status, Included in 'Conversions', Type, Scope, Count, and Conversion window. The table lists eight goals with their respective tracking statuses.

Goal name	Tracking status	Included in "Conversions"	Type	Scope	Count	Conversion window
CONTOSO_Direct_Sale	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Gen_Form	Tag inactive	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Demo_Booked	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
PreOrder_Submit	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Transaction_Complete	No recent conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Pricing_View	Unverified	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Outbound_Partner_Click	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
REG_Account_Created	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes

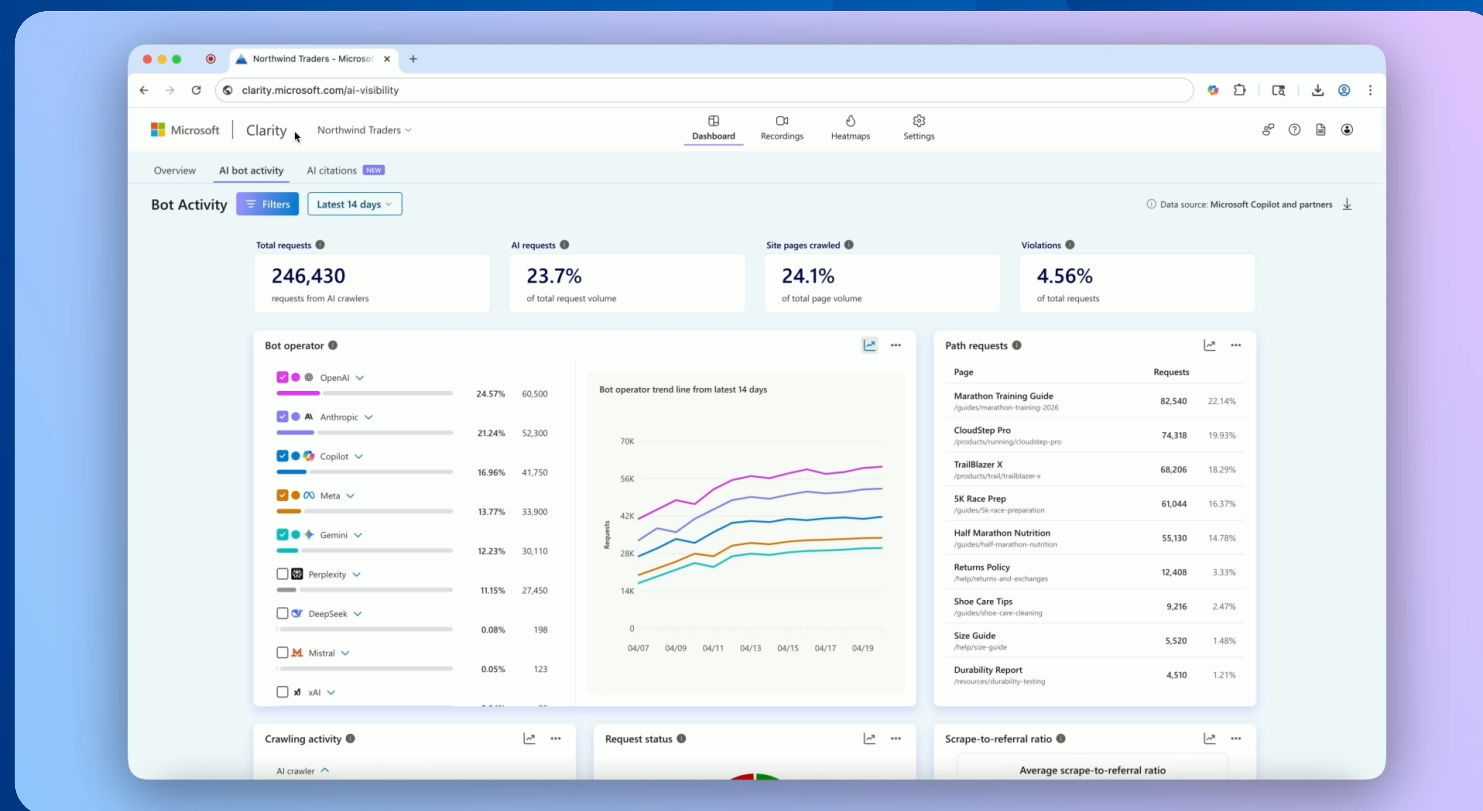
Rows per page: 25 of 31

Not all metrics are in real time. Clicks and Impressions in the last 1 hour; UET conversions in the last 2 hours; and Non-UET conversions (App Install, Offline Conversions) in the last 5 hours might not be included. [Learn more](#)
Only search ads clicks are MRC accredited; other metrics are not MRC accredited. [Learn more](#). The time zone for the date range is (GMT-05:00) Eastern Time (U.S. & Canada) [Learn more](#)

Microsoft Clarity

From AI discovery to on-site conversion

- **Get discovered in AI**
Clarity tracks how AI surfaces your brand
- **Know what to improve**
Clarity recommends how to lift visibility.
- **Win after the click**
Rage-clicks and drop-offs stay hidden.
Clarity reveals on-site behavior to optimize.



Wrap the basics — foundation readiness checklist

Before demand builds, confirm the campaign, feed, measurement, and bidding fundamentals are ready for AI-assisted discovery and peak-season scale.

Campaign mix & structure

- ☐ Confirm the right mix across Search, Shopping, AI Max, PMax, and Audience Ads.
- ☐ Consolidate low-volume campaigns or use portfolio strategies where learning is thin.
- ☐ Reserve Exact Match for must-have terms; use Broad Match, AI Max, and PMax for expansion.

Feeds & AI readiness

- ☐ Upload 100% of the catalog and complete UCP / Merchant Center settings.
- ☐ Enrich titles and descriptions with variant details, seasonal use cases, and valid IDs.
- ☐ Tag hero products, best sellers, promotions, and strategic inventory with custom labels.

Measurement & bidding

- ☐ Validate UET, conversion goals, attribution model, and conversion values end to end.
- ☐ Set up bidding experiments and seasonality adjustments early enough to learn.

WINNING HOLIDAY MOMENTS

Phase 2: Gift Them A Reason



Phase 02

– September / October
Gift them a Reason

Create demand

1. Expand reach and **increase visibility ahead of peak** shopping moments
2. Connect with **untapped audiences** through:
 - LinkedIn Profile Targeting
 - Seasonal in-market audiences
 - New customer acquisition strategies
3. Influence shoppers earlier in their decision-making journey with **Impression-based remarketing**
4. **Optimize for seasonal relevance**
5. **Refresh creative** and promotional messaging to align with holiday trends
6. Adjust campaigns to **capitalize on seasonal demand shifts**
7. **Be relevant** throughout the shopping season

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 2:

Engage during peak season

Driving awareness, consideration, and customer engagement



"Search is enough."

"Creative doesn't matter during the holidays."

"We should focus only on existing customers."

- Shoppers engage across multiple channels before converting, and **AI Max, Performance Max, Shopping, and Audience Ads** help create, expand, and **capture demand** along the journey.
- **Seasonal messaging**, offers, and urgency can significantly impact performance.
- Holiday growth often attracts new shoppers earlier in the buying journey, making **upper-funnel engagement** a key driver of conversions before the final click.
- The holiday season is one of the biggest **opportunities** to acquire **new customers**.

The average Holiday conversion journey is 52 days

Strong visibility throughout the **full season** is critical to engaging and re-engaging holiday shoppers.

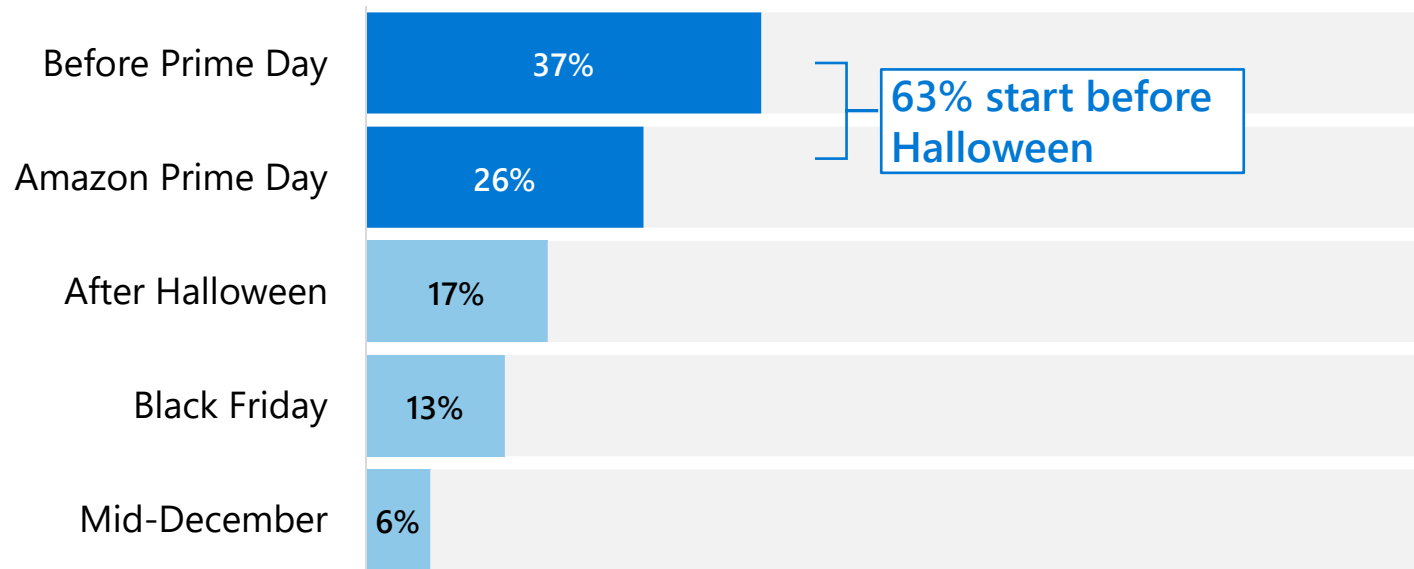
- ✓ Create awareness early with upper funnel Audience Ad tactics.
- ✓ Build and target robust remarketing lists to re-engage consumers, during and post Cyber-5.



Oct Prime Day starts holiday shopping for many consumers

When Holiday shoppers plan to start

Share of Respondents



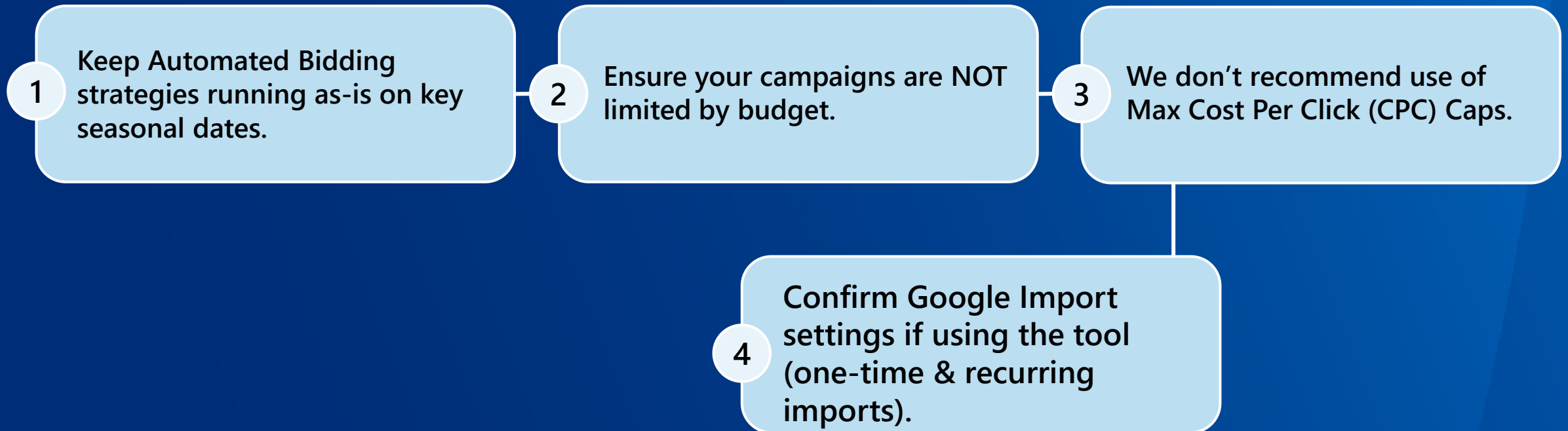
Before October Prime Day have ready

- Holiday messaging
- Product feeds
- Budgets
- Full-funnel coverage



to capture early demand

Best practices to consider both in your prep and during peak days



Seasonal in-market audiences

Seasonal segments are lists of people ready to buy for a particular event, like Black Friday or Christmas.

Seasonal segments use the same audience intelligence as existing In-market audience segments, and are infused with additional signals related to the seasonal event to deliver a relevant user segment of likely converters.

Black Friday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/in-store Black Friday shopping.
- Seasonal shopping/Black Friday shopping/online Black Friday shopping.

Christmas holiday segments

US, CA, UK, DE, FR, AU, NZ

- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/after-Christmas sale shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/in-store Christmas shopping
- Seasonal shopping/Christmas shopping/online Christmas shopping

Cyber-5 generates 9% of holiday conversions with just 7% of clicks as shoppers are highly engaged and ready to purchase.



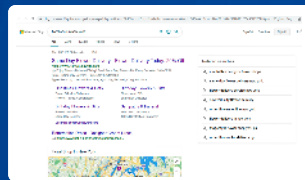
Re-engage audiences with impression-based remarketing

Target people who've seen your ads, even if they haven't clicked, with sequential messaging that guides them from initial interest to conversion.

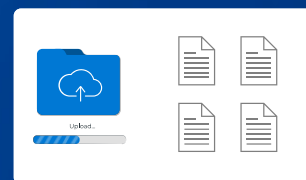
Audience Ads influence 41% of first touchpoints, highlighting their role in introducing and nurturing shoppers early in the journey.



Olivia is in-market for a holiday gift...



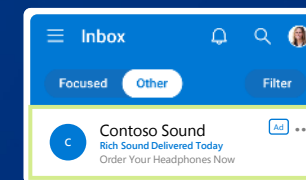
Olivia is searching on Bing for wireless earbuds. She sees your ad, but clicks on a competitor.



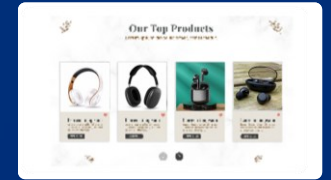
Olivia is placed in your impression-based remarketing list.



The next day, she visits MSN and sees your ad, keeping your brand top of mind.



Later, while checking emails, she sees your ad, clicks, and visits your site.



Olivia chooses to buy wireless earbuds from your company and checks out on your site.

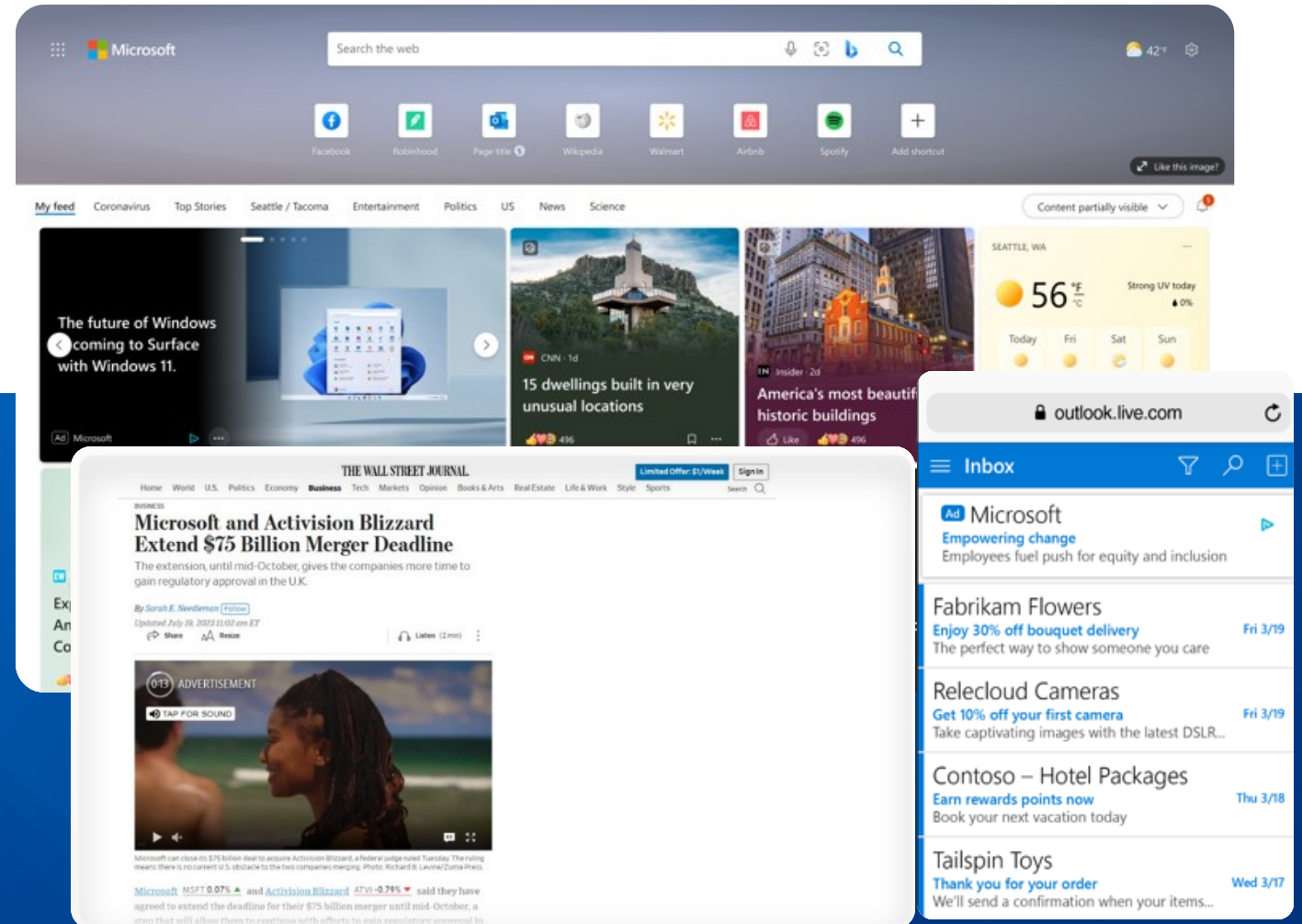
Drive higher engagement in contextually relevant environments

Placement targeting

Exclusively serve ads on premium Microsoft properties such as MSN, Outlook, Microsoft Casual Games, King games and more

Topic targeting

Pinpoint specific topics that align with your brand and audience to ensure your ads appear on sites with contextually relevant content



LOOKFANTASTIC

Turns beauty trends into cart conversions

Audiences



The challenge

- Traditionally relied on lower-funnel Search campaigns to capture existing demand
- Needed to engage beauty shoppers earlier in the purchase journey amid intense competition

The objective

- Determine whether upper-funnel media investment could drive measurable business outcomes beyond awareness

The solution

- **Build attention at scale and reinforce the message using [Audience ads](#):** The team could reach beauty shoppers while competitors focused heavily on search. Image-led Native formats kept their brand top of mind.
- **Turn views into action through [impression-based remarketing](#):** The strategy reconnected users who had seen ads and re-engaged them through Search when they were ready to buy.
- **Activate high-intent signals using Microsoft [in-market audiences](#):** First-party data and customer match layering helped balance prospecting and re-engagement with in-market audiences.

The results

2.7x Conversion lift from in-market audiences

76% Video view-through rate

56% Revenue generated from remarketing

Refine your assets for holiday with Ads Studio

Microsoft Advertising Platform

- Type in a text prompt to generate a new background
- Hover over example images to see example prompts
- Click **Apply background** to add to your library. Saved as a copy to your original image.

CHRISTMAS ATMOSPHERE



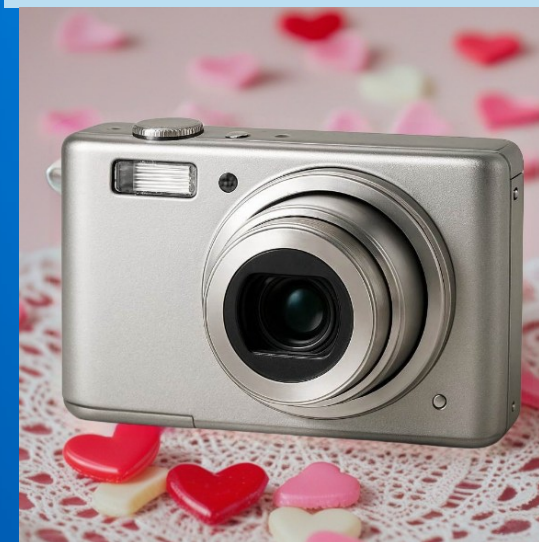
HALLOWEEN SCENE



LUNAR NEW YEAR



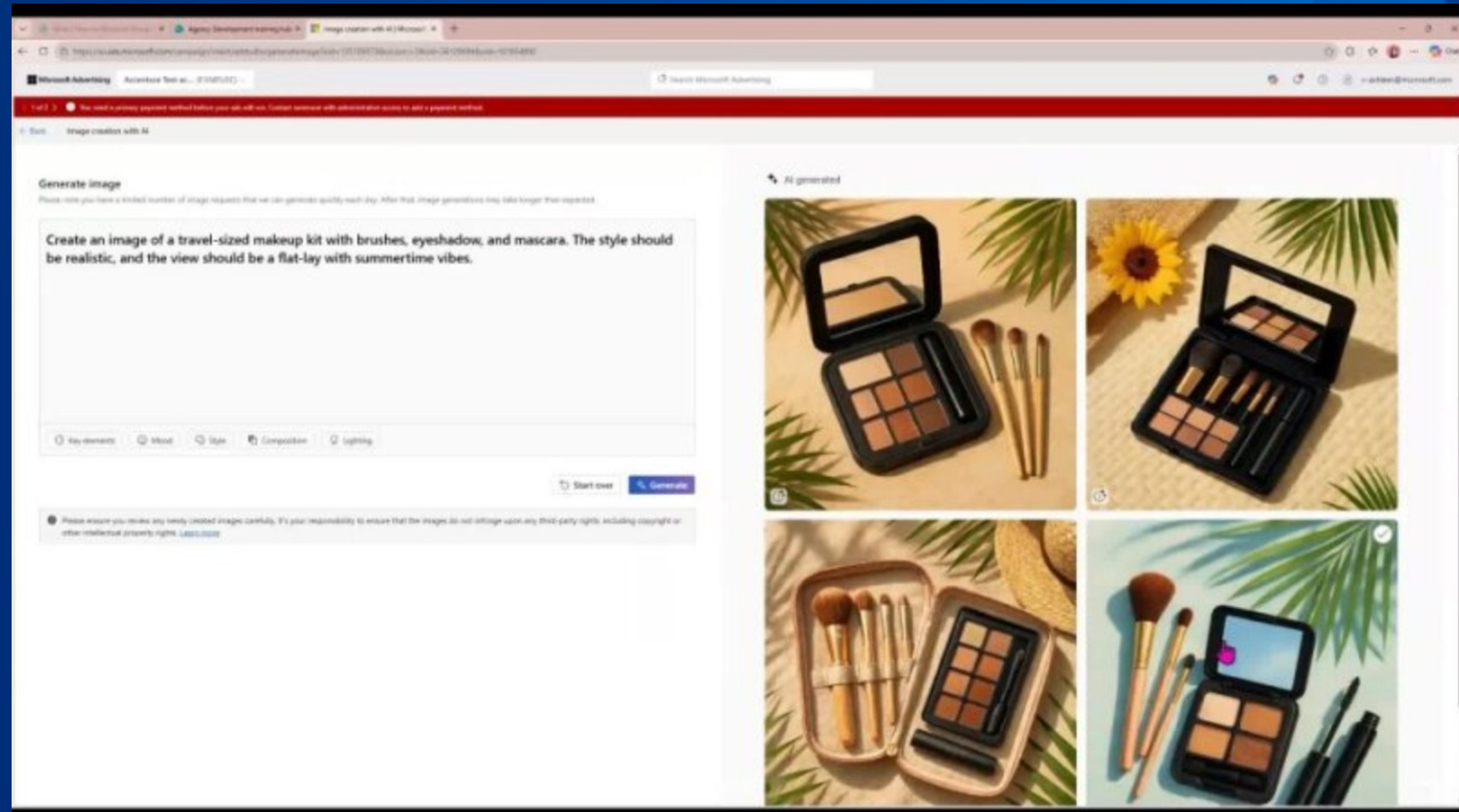
VALENTINE'S DAY SCENE



PHASE 2- KEEP YOUR ASSETS RELEVANT

Make your assets seasonal

- Minimum images for asset groups: *1.91:1 ratio and 1:1 ratio*
- Use the Ad Preview tool for aspect ratios
- Turn on auto-generated assets
- Leverage Assets reporting for optimization
- Customize assets background based on campaign structure and audience signals with Copilot in Microsoft Advertising Platform
- Choose compelling images. No text



Gift them a reason — demand creation checklist

Use September and October to create consideration, build reachable audiences, and refresh the seasonal message before shoppers are ready to buy.

Audience development

- ☐ Build remarketing, Customer Match, dynamic remarketing, and impression-based lists now.
- ☐ Separate prospecting and retargeting so bids, offers, and messages can differ.
- ☐ Activate seasonal in-market, similar audience, LinkedIn, and new-customer signals.

Creative & context

- ☐ Refresh creative with seasonal offer, gift, and urgency angles ahead of October demand.
- ☐ Use placement and topic targeting to show up in relevant Microsoft environments.
- ☐ Use Ads Studio / Copilot to adapt product imagery and backgrounds for each moment.

Bidding & readiness

- ☐ Monitor targets and budgets during the ramp; avoid budget limits that suppress demand.
- ☐ Confirm automated bidding and Google Import settings are stable before peak.

Phase 3: Ring in the Sales!



Phase 03 Ring in the sales – November / December

Capture Demand at Peak Moments

- Ensure campaigns are **fully optimized** and ready to scale
- Maximize reach and efficiency with **Performance Max** and **AI Max**
- Schedule **promotions** in advance to support key shopping events
- Maintain **sufficient budget headroom** to capture rising demand

Stay Agile Throughout the Season

- **Refresh creative assets** regularly to prevent fatigue
- **Evolve audience strategies** as shopper behavior changes
- Monitor performance daily to **identify optimization opportunities**

Myths of holidays past: debunking holiday advertising misconceptions

Phase 3: Ring in the Sales!

When shoppers are ready to buy



"The competitive landscape is static throughout the season."

"Shopping campaigns don't need optimization."

"There are so many shoppers, promotions aren't necessary."

- Feed quality, product titles, images, offers, and pricing all can impact performance.
- Holiday demand doesn't guarantee sales. Consumers are actively comparing prices, deals, and brands. Promotions, seasonal messaging, and compelling offers can help capture attention, improve conversion rates, and maximize your share of holiday demand.

October clicks fuel conversions well into the holiday season

Among nearly 500K holiday user paths, October was a key starting point as **56% of November conversions** and **35% of December conversions** originated from October clicks.

October was the starting point for **56% of November** and **35% of December conversions**.

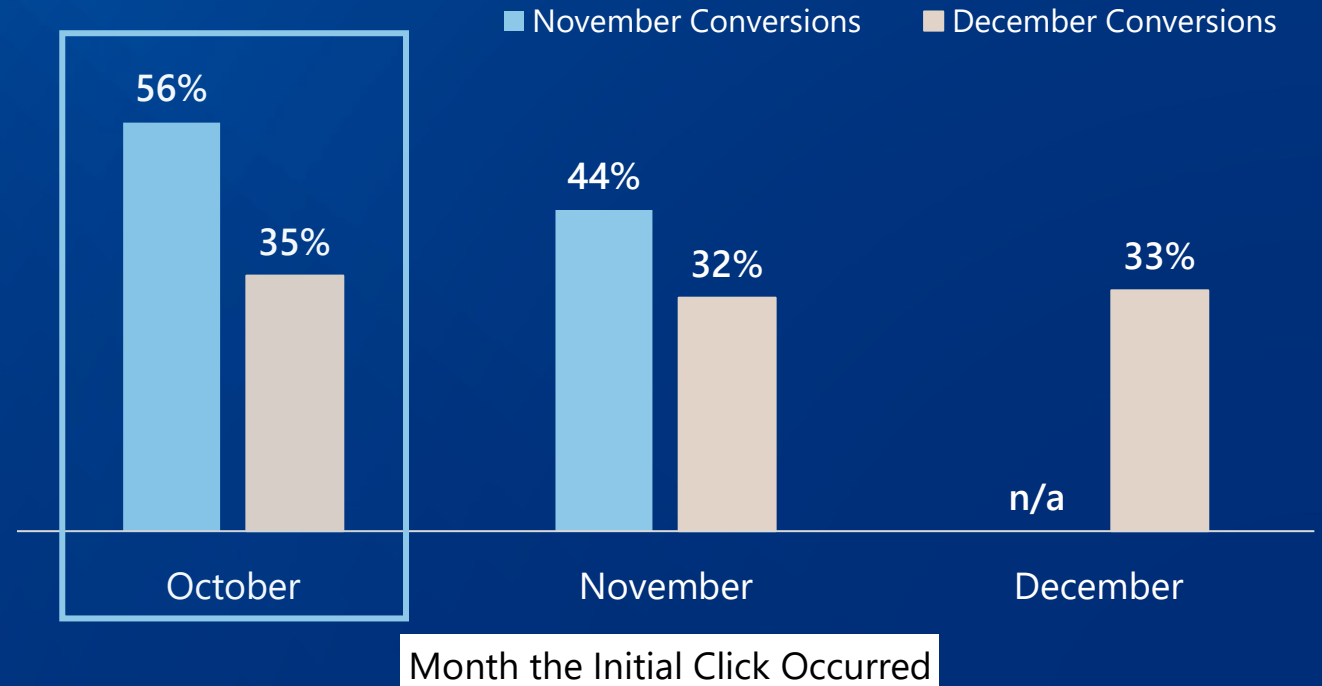
56%

Nov Conv

35%

Dec Conv

- ✓ Use October to drive more cost-efficient site traffic, build remarketing lists, and re-engage high-intent shoppers in November and December.



Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist – Phase 3

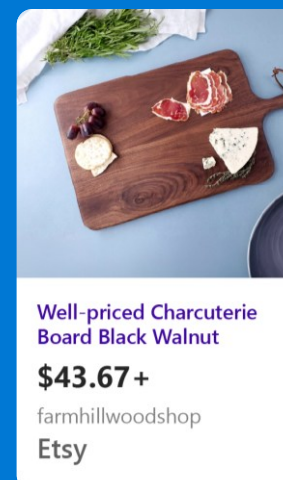
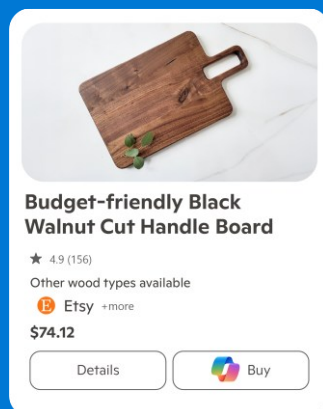
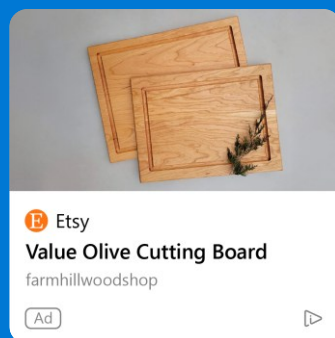


Pro tip: Use Product explorer in Merchant Center to easily view all products in your catalog, audit, and identify issues.

Highlight holiday shopping details, deals, and incentives.

- ☐ **Sale prices**
Show your discounted price
- ☐ **Pricing accuracy**
Keep pricing and availability accurate in real time.
- ☐ **Merchant promotions**
Offer shopping incentives like buy 1 get 1 free, discount codes, \$20 off \$100, etc.
- ☐ **Local Inventory ads**
Show local inventory availability
- ☐ **Curbside pickup**
- ☐ **Free Shipping**
- ☐ **Monitor feed health**
Audit the feed for disapprovals and missing attributes daily through peak
- ☐ **Additional images**
Show shoppers multiple product views.

AI-powered Performance Max helps you drive more conversions across Microsoft properties and formats



+8%
increase in incremental
conversions

Target and budget considerations

Leverage the bid landscape tool

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different targets.

Black Friday and Cyber Monday fall at month-end — monitor budget pacing so you aren't constrained in the peak moments.

Campaign bid landscape

Create a simulation of your campaign's performance using different Target ROAS. [Learn more](#)

Target ROAS	Weekly est. spend	Weekly est. clicks	Weekly est. Impr.	Weekly est. top Impr.	Weekly est. conv.	Weekly est. conv. value	Additional budget/daily required
☐ 1,920.00%	\$5,713.96	6,534	69,046	27,908	738	78,079	-
☐ 1,560.00%	\$5,830.78	6,607	70,337	29,199	744	78,622	-
☒ 1,200.00%	\$6,062.02	6,750	72,893	31,755	756	79,697	-
☐ 1,080.00%	\$6,199.24	6,836	74,409	33,271	763	80,334	-
☐ 840.00%	\$6,596.11	7,045	80,148	39,010	779	81,650	-
☐ 600.00%	\$7,231.08	7,291	90,368	49,230	797	82,490	-
☐ 240.00%	\$8,928.51	7,632	107,799	66,661	815	84,020	-
☐ Other %							



Reminder: Avoid capping your budgets

Hitting your budget caps should be avoided; it is better to use **targets** to control spend.

Apply to my campaign

Cancel

*This simulation is based on performance from 11/25/2024 to 12/1/2024. These are estimated figures and do not guarantee future results.

During the peak days,
monitor and optimize closely

1

If using Enhanced CPC,
continuously optimize base bids
as one of most important levers

2

For TCPA/TROAS, make Target
and Budget changes as needed.
There is no constraint on the
frequency of target changes.

3

Set conversion value rules
towards your performance goals

New Customer Acquisition

Microsoft Advertising Contoso US (123456789)

New performance max campaign

Assets
Targeting
Campaign details
Budget
Summary

How much do you want to spend?

Tell us about your campaign and how much you want to spend

Bid strategy

Which bid strategy do you want to use to manage your daily budget? *

Maximize conversions

Using the Maximize conversions bid strategy to help you get the most conversions for your budget.

☐ Set a target cost per action

Optimize new customer acquisition

Optimization strategy for new customers

☐ Bid higher for new customers

☒ Bid only for new customers

Existing customer segments *

Segment A Segment B Segment C

Edit customer acquisition

Budget

These are estimates based on businesses with similar ad settings and budget.

☒ Advanced

\$45/day | \$1,350/month

Monthly conversions 130 - 145
Monthly impressions
CTR 3%
Monthly clicks

BID UP FOR NEW CUSTOMERS ONLY, keep the same for existing customers

NEED TO KNOW/DO

- Set Maximize conversion value as your bid strategy.
- Target ROAS is optional.
- Create a Purchase conversion goal at the account level.

RECOMMENDED IF YOU WANT TO

- Maintain your scale and engagement with potential returning customers
- Have a higher conversion value set for new customers

TARGET AND BID ONLY FOR NEW CUSTOMERS

NEED TO KNOW/DO

- Optimize your bids to target new customers exclusively.
- Your audience list will help us optimize for targeting only new customers during ad delivery. This the audience we are excluding.

RECOMMENDED IF YOU HAVE:

- Strict budgets or creative assets for new users vs. returning users
- Non-purchase conversion goals like lead generation.
- Another PMax campaign for all customers.

Ring in the sales — peak capture checklist

During November and December, protect delivery, keep offers visible, and use automation signals to capture the holiday moments shoppers are ready to act on.

Peak execution

- ☐ Schedule promotions, sale prices, shipping, and local inventory details ahead of key dates.
- ☐ Check feed health daily for disapprovals, pricing, images, and availability issues.
- ☐ Maintain budget headroom for Cyber Week and avoid CPC caps that limit delivery.

PMax & bidding

- ☐ Add top-volume search themes, seasonal audiences, and refreshed Customer Match lists.
- ☐ Use seasonality adjustments when conversion-rate shifts are expected.
- ☐ Use targets, bid landscape, and conversion value rules to steer toward revenue or LTV.

Customer growth

- ☐ Set up new customer acquisition when higher new-customer value is justified.
- ☐ Refresh creative and audiences daily based on performance signals and product demand.

Phase 4: Unbox What's Next!



Phase 04

Unbox what's next

– **December / January**

1. Monitor performance

- Monitor **post-holiday performance** to identify new opportunities
- Account for **conversion delays** before evaluating campaign success
- Use **performance insights and KPIs** to identify optimization opportunities

2. Adapt strategies & messaging

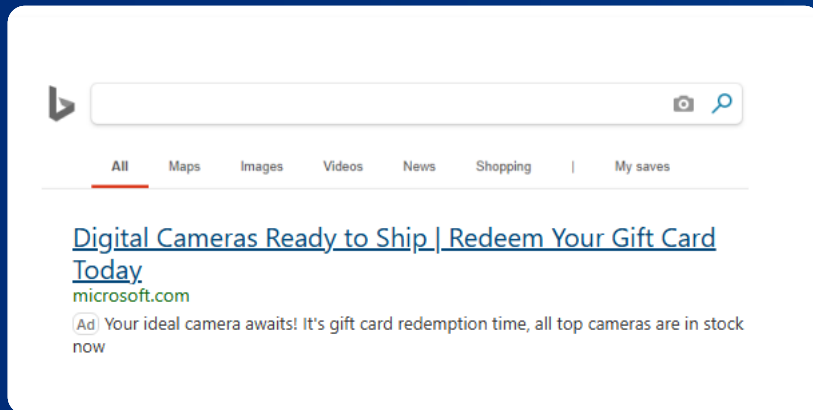
- Refine **bids, targets, budgets, and messaging** as consumer behavior evolves
- **Adjust strategies** to align with changing demand and seasonal priorities

3. Apply insights & grow

- Apply learnings to build momentum and **capture continued growth** post Holiday rush

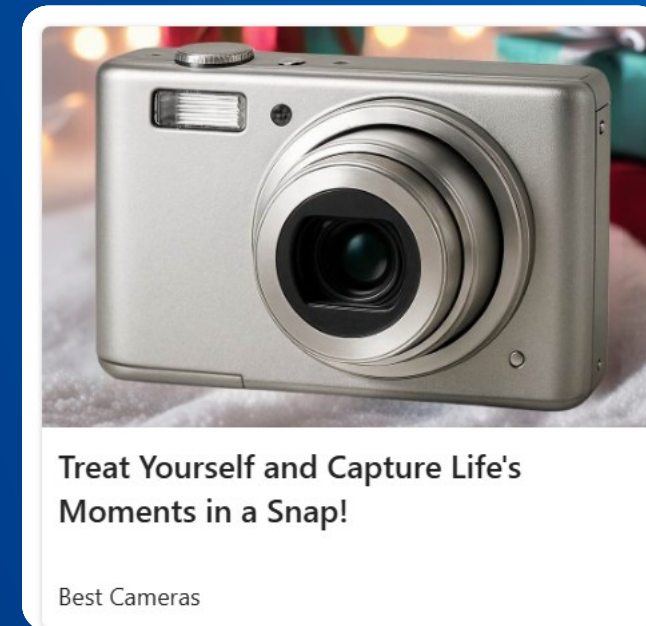
Post-holiday messaging

Run dedicated **gift-card redemption campaigns** with bonus-value offers and upgrade promotions.



Extend urgency through limited-time post-holiday and clearance events.

Refresh creative to align with post-holiday shopper intent and New Year motivations.



Post-holiday is still a conversion window

Help shoppers finish, exchange, redeem, and save — not just “treat yourself.”

01

Late shoppers

Promote gift cards, subscriptions, and instant digital delivery.

02

Exchanges & returns

Offer easy swaps, alternatives, bundles, and reorder prompts.

03

Post-holiday sales

Use clearance, bonus value, and New Year reset messaging.

04

Gift cards

Nudge redemption with add-ons, upgrades, and reminder campaigns.

Keep messaging active: finish it · fix it · redeem it · save now

Unbox what's next — measurement & learning checklist

After peak, keep momentum moving: pivot the message, measure with conversion delays in mind, and capture learnings for the next holiday cycle.

Post-holiday demand

- ☐ Pivot messaging to gift cards, digital delivery, clearance, returns, and New Year goals.
- ☐ Run redemption or bonus-value offers to extend the customer journey.
- ☐ Keep campaigns live for last-minute and post-holiday shoppers; adjust gradually.

Measurement

- ☐ Account for conversion delays before judging late-season performance.
- ☐ Review KPIs by phase, audience, campaign type, product set, and offer.
- ☐ Compare learnings from October clicks, Cyber Week, and December / January demand.

Next-season actions

- ☐ Document which feed, audience, creative, bidding, and budget moves worked.
- ☐ Turn findings into next year's testing roadmap and early setup checklist.

Tie the bow— holiday readiness core checklist

Use this final pass to confirm the foundation, demand creation, peak capture, and learning motions are ready across the full holiday cycle.

PHASE 01

Wrap the basics

- ☐ Media strategy ready
- ☐ Product feed & UCP set
- ☐ UET and goals validated
- ☐ Active Conversion values
- ☐ Experiments set

PHASE 02

Gift them a reason

- ☐ Audience lists built
- ☐ Seasonal signals activated
- ☐ Creative refreshed early
- ☐ Placements and topics aligned
- ☐ Bidding/import settings stable

PHASE 03

Ring in the sales

- ☐ Promotions scheduled
- ☐ Feed health checked daily
- ☐ Peak budget headroom secured
- ☐ PMax themes & audiences refreshed
- ☐ New-customer value reviewed

PHASE 04

Unbox what's next

- ☐ Post-holiday message pivoted
- ☐ Conversion delays accounted for
- ☐ KPIs reviewed by phase
- ☐ Learnings documented
- ☐ Next-year roadmap started

Mark each box as teams confirm readiness across Search, Shopping, Audience Ads, PMax, feeds, measurement, and post-peak learning.

Thank you